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November 1, 1963
SUPERSEDING
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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

HANDLES; WOOD, MISCELLANEOUS (FOR) TOOLS

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington 25, D. C., based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. - This specification covers handles for use on chisels, files, saws, and nonelectric soldering irons (copper).

1.1.1 Federal specification coverage. - Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification. - The handles shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Chisel handles, socket firmer
- Size 1 (small)
- Size 2 (medium)
- Size 3 (large)

Type II - Files handles
- Size 1 (small)
- Size 2 (medium)
- Size 3 (large)

Type III - Saw handles

Type IV - Soldering iron handles

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. - The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification.

Federal Standards:
- Fed. Std. No. 102 - Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
- Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

FOR INSTRUCTIONS ON OBTAINING COPIES OF FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS, SEE LAST PAGE.

Military Specification:
- MIL-H-15424 - Hand Tools, Packaging of.

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Illustrations. - The illustrations shown herein are for the convenience of identification and are not intended to preclude the purchase of handles which are otherwise in accordance with this specification.

3.2 Material. - Chisel handles shall be hickory or hard maple. Saw handles shall be applewood, beech or laminated wood as specified in the procurement document. File handles and soldering iron handles shall be of any species of wood used commercially for the purpose.

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3.3 Quality.- Handles shall be sound and free of defects. The ferrules shall be free of burrs and rust which may affect the appearance or serviceability of the handle.

3.4 Moisture content.- The moisture content of handles shall not exceed 15 percent.

3.5 Dimensions.- Chisel, file and soldering iron handles shall conform to the dimensions of the respective figures and tables incorporated herein with tolerances of plus or minus 1/8 inch in transverse dimensions and plus or minus 1/2 inch in overall dimensions. Saw handles shall conform to the details given in the procurement document.

3.6 Type I, chisel handles.- Type I handles shall be similar to figure 1 and shall conform to table I for the size specified (see 6.2). Each handle shall be capped or tipped with layers of leather, totaling a minimum of 3/8 inch in thickness. The leather shall be secured to the handle and shaped so as to withstand the blows of mallets or hammers.

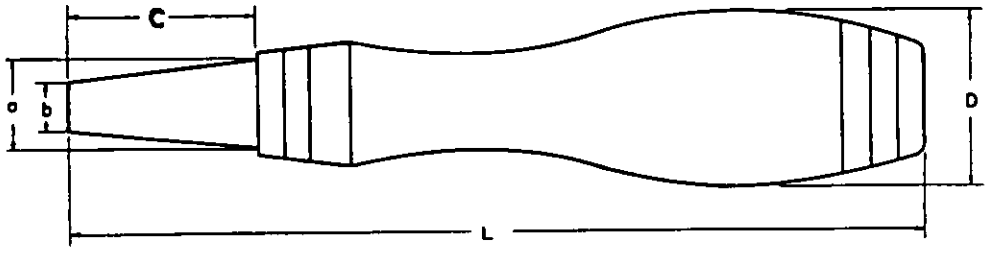


Figure 1. - Type I, chisel handles

Table I. - Type I, chisel handles

Size	Largest diameter D	Overall length L	Tapered portion		
			Largest a	Smallest b	Length ± 1/8 inch c
	Inches	Inches	Inch	Inch	Inches
1 (Small)	1	5-1/4	11/16	1/2	1-1/16
2 (Medium)	1-3/16	5-3/8	3/4	9/16	1-1/4
3 (Large)	1-3/16	5-1/2	7/8	5/8	1-1/4

3.7 Type II, file handles. - Type II handles shall be similar to figure 2 and shall conform to table II for the size specified (see 6.2). The front or small end of file handles shall be equipped with a substantial metal ferrule, at least 1/4 the length of the handle or an equally effective device designed to prevent the handle from splitting when the tang end of the file is inserted (forced) into the handle under service conditions. If equipped with a metal ferrule, the ferrule shall be seamless and fabricated of not less than 22 gage (1/32-inch) material. Each metal ferrule shall be impressed around its full diameter in a manner to prevent separation of the ferrule from the handle. Each handle shall be drilled axially to half its length with a hole to accept the tang end of files (see table II).

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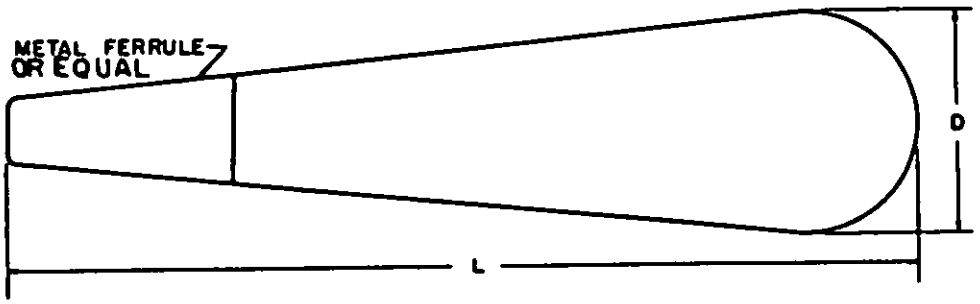


Figure 2. - Type II, file handles

Table II. - Type II, file handles

Size	Diameter of handle D ± 1/16	Overall length L ± 1/8	Suitable for files of the following lengths	Diameter of drilled hole for tang end
	Inches	Inches	Inches	Inch
1 (Small)	1	4	3 - 6	1/8
2 (Medium)	1-1/4	4-1/2	6 - 10	11/64
3 (Large)	1-1/2	5-1/2	10 - 14	5/16

3.8 Type III, saw handles. - Type III handles shall be in accordance with the requirements of the procurement document.

3.9 Type IV, soldering iron handles. - Type IV handles shall conform to the dimensions of and be similar to figure 3. Each handle shall be equipped with a suitable metal ferrule secured to the handle. Each handle shall be drilled axially to half its length with a hole of suitable diameter to accept the tang end of a soldering iron.

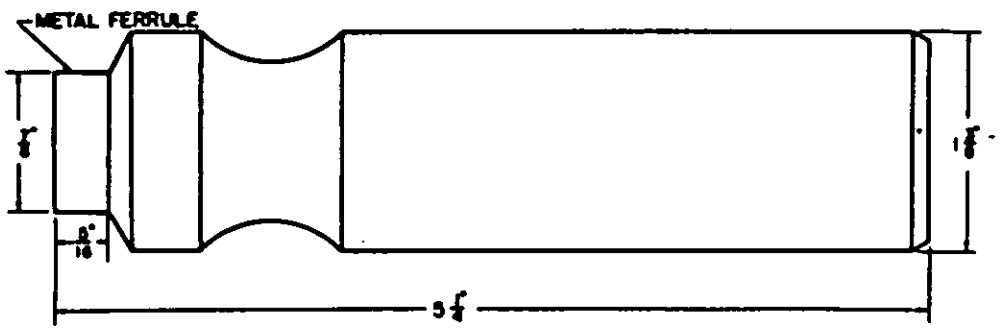


Figure 3. - Type IV, soldering iron handle

3.10 Finish. - All handles shall be smoothly finished. (See 6.4 and Appendix A).

3.11 Marking. - The handles shall be marked in a plain and permanent manner, preferably foil or steel stamped, with the manufacturer's name, symbol or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

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3.12 *Workmanship.*- The workmanship shall be of the highest grade throughout and in accordance with good commercial practice.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.-

4.2.1 Inspection lot.- All handles of the same type and size offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of inspection.

4.2.2 Sampling for inspection.- A random sample of handles shall be selected from each lot for inspection. The size of the sample and the acceptance and rejection numbers shall be as indicated in table III.

Table III. - Sampling for inspection.

Lot size	Sample size	Acceptance number	Rejection number
2 to 15	lot size	0	1
16 to 110	15	0	1
111 to 800	35	1	2
801 to 1300	50	2	3
1301 to 3200	75	3	4
3201 and over	150	5	6

4.3 Inspection.-

4.3.1 Visual and dimensional inspection.- Each of the sample handles selected in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be inspected to verify compliance with this specification. Any handle in the sample containing one or more visual or dimensional defects, or which has been rejected for moisture content as specified in 4.4.1, shall be rejected and if the number of rejected handles in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

4.4 Test procedures.-

4.4.1 Moisture content.- Each of the sample handles selected in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be tested to verify compliance with the moisture content requirement of 3.4. An electrical moisture meter or other equally suitable method shall be used to determine moisture content. Any handle in the sample having a moisture content in excess of 15 percent shall be rejected.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civilian agencies, Federal Standard No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging and packing for civilian procurement.)

5.1 Preservation and packaging.-

5.1.1 Level A.- The handles shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with level A of Specification MIL-H-15424 as specified for wood file handles.

5.1.2 Level C.- The handles shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with the supplier's standard practice.

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5.2 Packing.-

5.2.1 Level A.- Handles shall be packed in accordance with level A of Specification MIL-H-15424 as specified for wood file handles.

5.2.2 Level B.- Handles shall be packed in accordance with level B of Specification MIL-H-15424 as specified for wood file handles.

5.2.3 Level C.- The handles shall be shipped in accordance with standard commercial practice, so as to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest rate. Containers and method of shipment shall be in accordance with rules and regulations as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.-

5.3.1 Civil agencies.- In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order (see 6.2), each unit and intermediate package and shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order (see 6.2), or herein, interior and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Specification MIL-H-15424.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- This specification is intended to cover the purchase of handles for chisels, files, handsaws (replacement only) and soldering irons.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should include the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type and size of handles required (see 1.2, 3.6 and 3.7).
(c) Level of preservation, packaging and packing required (see section 5).
(d) Specify if any special marking is required (see 5.3).

6.3 Transportation description.-

6.3.1 Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail
Handles, wooden, not otherwise indexed by name, finished.
Carload minimum weight 36,000 pounds.

Motor
Handles, wooden, not otherwise indexed, other than in the rough.
Motor volume minimum weight 36,000 pounds.

6.4 Treatment.- Sometimes rough bolts as well as unfinished squares and stored handles are severely damaged by infestations of insects, generally Lyctus powder-post beetles. Bolts cut during the season when insects are active are subject to attack by Lyctus beetles as soon as the moisture content is below 20 percent. This is also true of unfinished squares or manufactured but unfinished handle stock and similar items. Fortunately Lyctus attack can be prevented by dipping the wood items in an insecticide. To be effective, the insecticide must be applied to raw wood since it will not penetrate paints, varnishes, lacquers, waxes or other finishing materials. For those who are interested in insecticide dips, a consideration of Appendix A is suggested. The methods described therein may be specified in connection with the procurement of handles or they may be followed by the purchaser.

Lyctus infestations can be very costly. Adequate treatments are relatively inexpensive and should be included as part of the manufacturing process.

Notice.- See Last Page.

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APPENDIX A. - TREATMENT TO PREVENT INFESTATION

1. Treatment

1.1 Turned handles.- After turning and before installing ferrules or leather caps, as applicable, dip the handles for 3 minutes in a solution of DDT, conforming to Federal Specification O-I-531. Care shall be exercised to prevent DDT solution from coming into contact with those dipping the handles. The handles shall be allowed to drain and dry before shipping or storing.

1.2 Bolts and unmanufactured squares.- Green bolts may be protected from Lyctus infestation by giving them a 10 second dip in a 5 percent water emulsion of DDT. Seasoned (10 to 15 percent moisture content) bolts and unmanufactured squares may be treated as stipulated for turned handles.

2. Determination of the presence of DDT.- From a treated handle plane off 1/4 inch and discard the shavings. Take the next fairly thick shaving for submission to a selected laboratory for testing as follows:

2.1 Preparation of reagent.- Seventy-five millimeters (ml.) of reagent grade pyridine and 50 grams of potassium hydroxide pellets shall be heated for 1 hour on a steam bath in a liter Erlenmeyer flask, fitted with an all glass reflux condenser. The pyridine shall be cooled and decanted into a second Erlenmeyer flask containing an additional 50 grams of potassium hydroxide and shall then be cooled, decanted and distilled in an all glass distillation apparatus. Two-tenths percent water and 0.2 percent xanthydrol shall be added to the distillate.

2.2 Test procedure.- Scrapings or thin shavings from the handle shall be placed in a beaker and covered with benzene. The benzene shall be brought to a boil and then filtered into a test tube. The benzene solution shall be evaporated to dryness. Five ml. of the pyridine xanthydrol solution and four pellets of potassium hydroxide shall be added and heated to boiling for 3 to 5 minutes. The reagent alone develops a yellow color changing to a dark green which on cooling reverts to a light greenish yellow color. When DDT is present, a red color develops first, followed by a dark green.

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